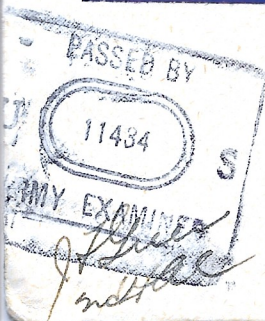


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VIA AIR MAIL



Miss MARtha Louise DARROUGH
LUTHERAN Hospital
School of Nursing.
ST. Louis 18
Mo.

May 16, 1945
England

Dear Marty,

I got a very nice & long
letter from you but before I got to
answering ~~the~~ letter I got a couple
before that. and as I only answer
one letter at a time it will take a
while before I answer this letter.
But I got to get some thing straight
now. When & if I do get home it
will take a while. and I am
not going to be the first ones home,
more like the last ones home. The
boys in combat are just as far as I am
not a never was in combat. I will
be at the end. It is a good way to
tell you but that is the way I got it in
about 2 years I can think. Think of
that. It is hard to take as I feel bad
for a while when I hear it. But I
just a soon take a while & come
back then not get back at all.

But if I had and still get those very good letters from you it will not be so hard. I wrote a letter to mother today. That one of the first things I am going to do after I get home is to write to you, is to look you up no matter where you are. I had a dream I came home to N.Y. and passed through you here town & got home just as I could see you and did I see you city. The rest of it will have I wait until I get home.

We had a baseball a soft ball game last week which I did not write you about. We finally won. Was gone by the score of 10 & 9. There was a hard game during as they had us a great part of the game. I had a good day at the place.

But yesterday, the weather was good so we had another game. And this one we got back to our old way. Had lost to the other side 7-1 a good game until

the last inning. I was 281 in all I
made 2 good throws in. There's 5
18. I played 35 this game. The last one
I was a catcher & the one before that
I played outfield. The next game
I will play outfield. And the game
out the catch. But we lost
the game on my bad play. I hit
it off I didn't get a hit.
What a day. I guess we all got
bad sleep but this one took the
cake.

To help me out I got some very
nice letters. The letters say she
kissed me about the neck. But she
it is keeping up?

Dad got letters like this from
mother in the last war. I wrote
to her. I guess Dad told her
that she didn't do that in
the last war. You see they didn't
want to get married while they had
a war on. So Dad went to the Navy
for a short time as the war was

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over foot that time. And when he
saw he had to find a job, so that
is why not the first not that worried
until she was about 26. But enough
of the Hoffeldts.

I am sure remember some of these
dates we had that you wrote about
in your letters. And I will try to
remember you said that you tried to
find some body else. I know if you did
not & still feel like you did now. that
I must mean a lot to you. I guess really
do not know just how much. As you
say you can tell me better. I have
been waiting for that day.

Dad always told me that the best part
of mother & his fights are the kiss
afterwards. I see that it is a little
in your mind also. But I do not think
we had a fight. And I hope it was
Dad's way. I go to work now as I used to
now. So I must be. I am coming
in this letter all my love so I hope
that you take care of it. Love always.
Dad.